

Abi

Can a machine learn why a creative choice belongs?

Abi is an attempt to build a machine ear for creative necessity. Can a system learn why a word, image, sentence, revision, or ending belongs inside one particular work?

| A choice belongs when changing it would weaken what the work is trying to make happen.

David Cope and style vs. necessity

David Cope's EMI showed that computation could generate music in recognizable styles.

Style

Asks whether a work *resembles* a composer or tradition.

EMI could produce Bach-like counterpoint, Chopin-like nocturnes — outputs that passed stylistic recognition tests.

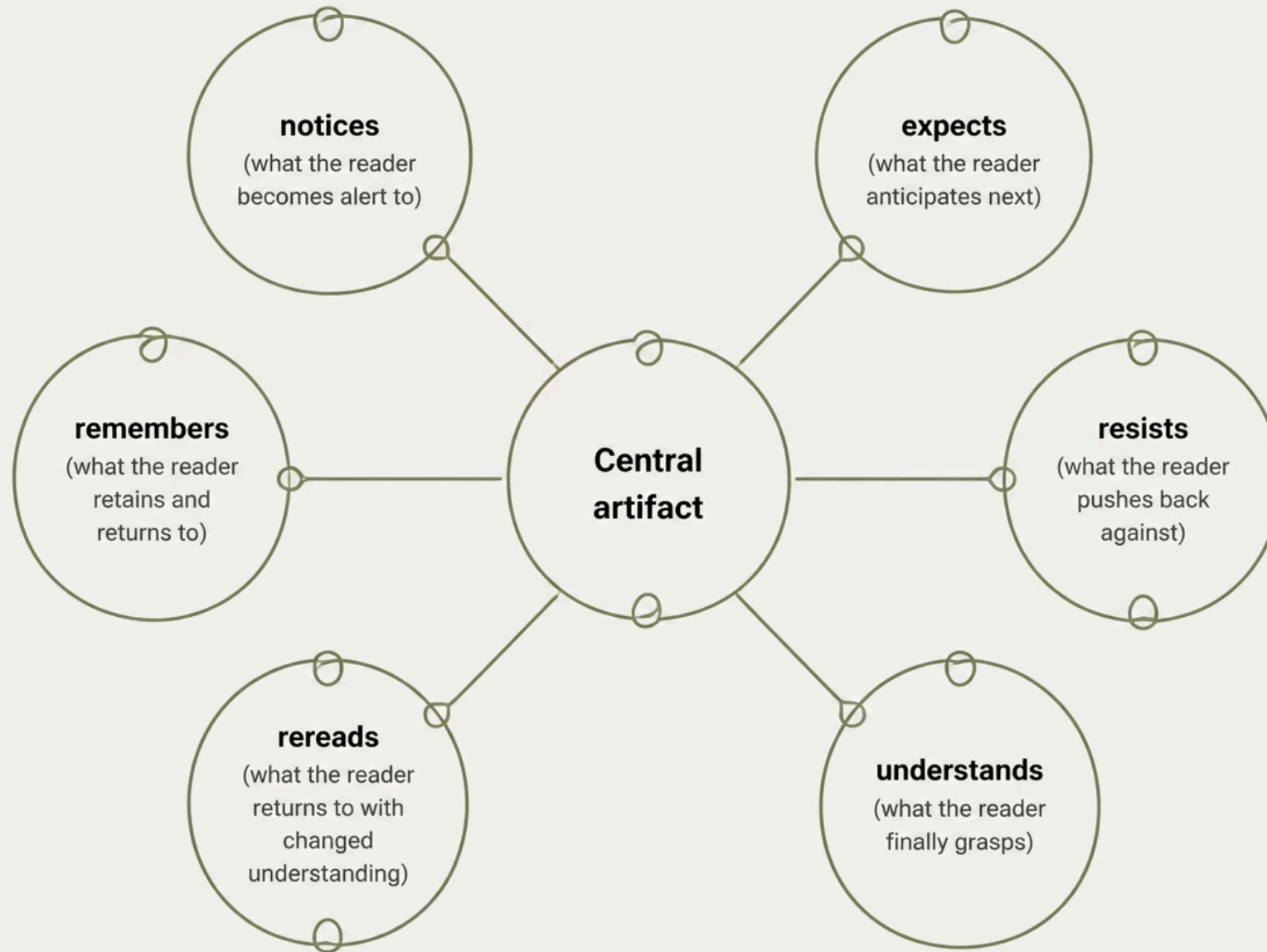
Creative necessity

Asks whether a choice *belongs* in one artifact.

Not: does this sound like the tradition? But: does this note, phrase, or turn belong here, in this particular work?

A work is a causal object

The previous target was surface quality. Abi models what the work *causes* in simulated readers.



A finished work changes what the observer notices, expects, remembers, resists, rereads, and understands. These are not impressions — they are the causal record of what the work did.

Rereading changes meaning

A work's ending changes the observer's account of the opening theme. A detail that first looked incidental can become the first sign of the whole structure.

1

Opening theme

A detail appears. It seems incidental — background, texture, noise.

2

Ending

The structure resolves. The ending earns its return.

3

Reread opening

The same detail is now the *first sign* of the whole structure.

A better revision loop is not enough

A stronger model can rewrite the draft. The result may be smoother, clearer, or more impressive. But that is not the same as creative repair.

Black-box rewrite

- Draft
- → Smoother draft

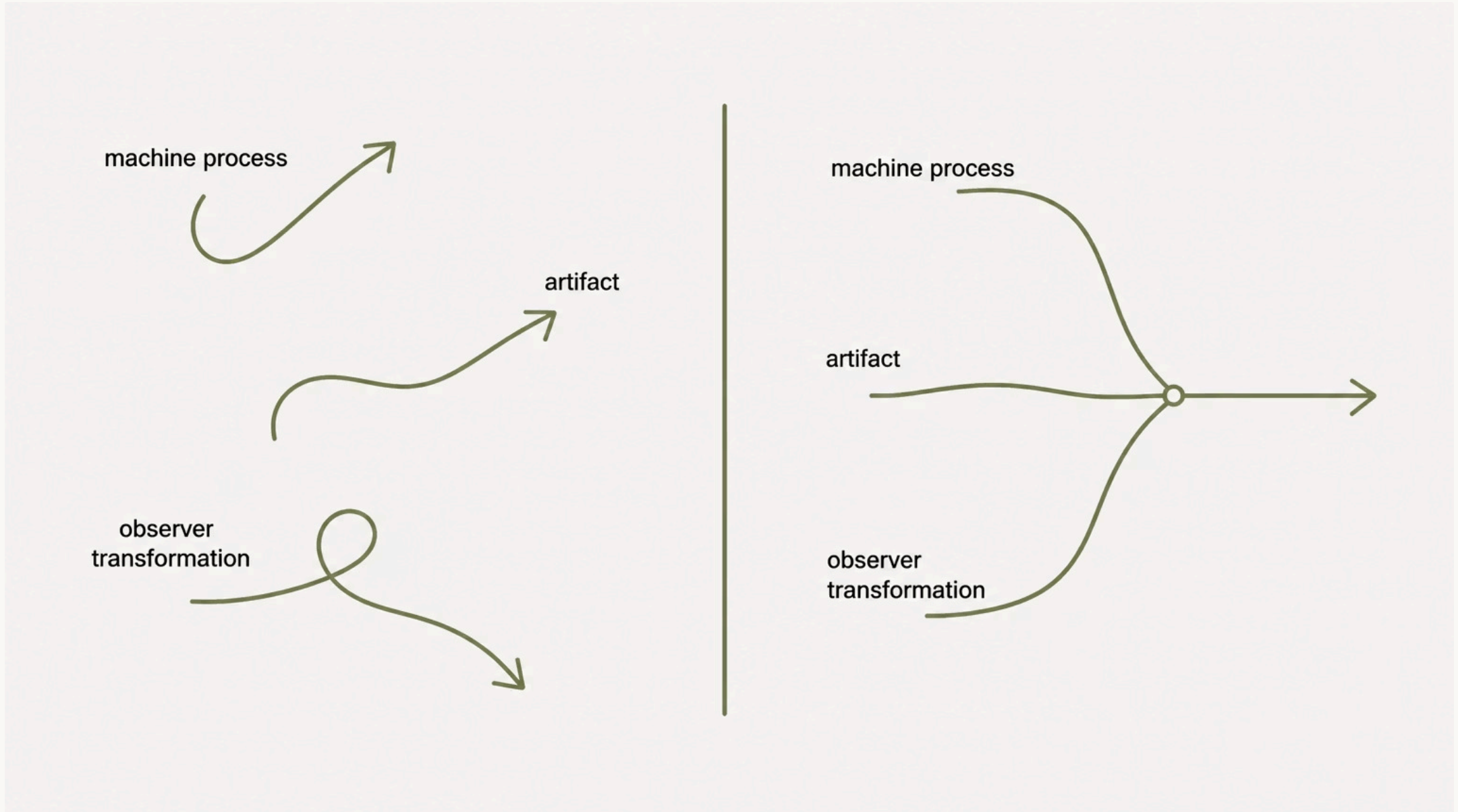
No knowledge of what failed or why. Each rewrite starts over.

Tracked creative repair

- Draft
- → Named failure
- → Reader transformation
- → Targeted repair

Without alignment, the system learns the wrong lesson

A revision loop can drift and overcorrect, optimizing for general clarity when the real problem is form. The machine process, the artifact, and the observer's transformation must answer the same question. Alignment is what makes failure legible.



Form under pressure

Abi began with a theory of form, that separation becomes convincing only by becoming lawful, pressured, and hard to overcome.

1

Local field

A great work creates a local field — a bounded space with its own rules of belonging.

2

Rules

The field gives itself rules. These are not external constraints — they are internal laws.

3

Pressure

The rules generate immense pressure. Collapse feels near. The return is not guaranteed.

4

Narrow return

Return happens according to the same rules. It is earned, not assumed.

The same framework in three places

Abi is designed to write about the framework and is also built around it.

Machine

Abi begins from a **germ**, develops pressure through critique, and returns through revision. The system enacts the same arc it is trying to produce.

Artifact

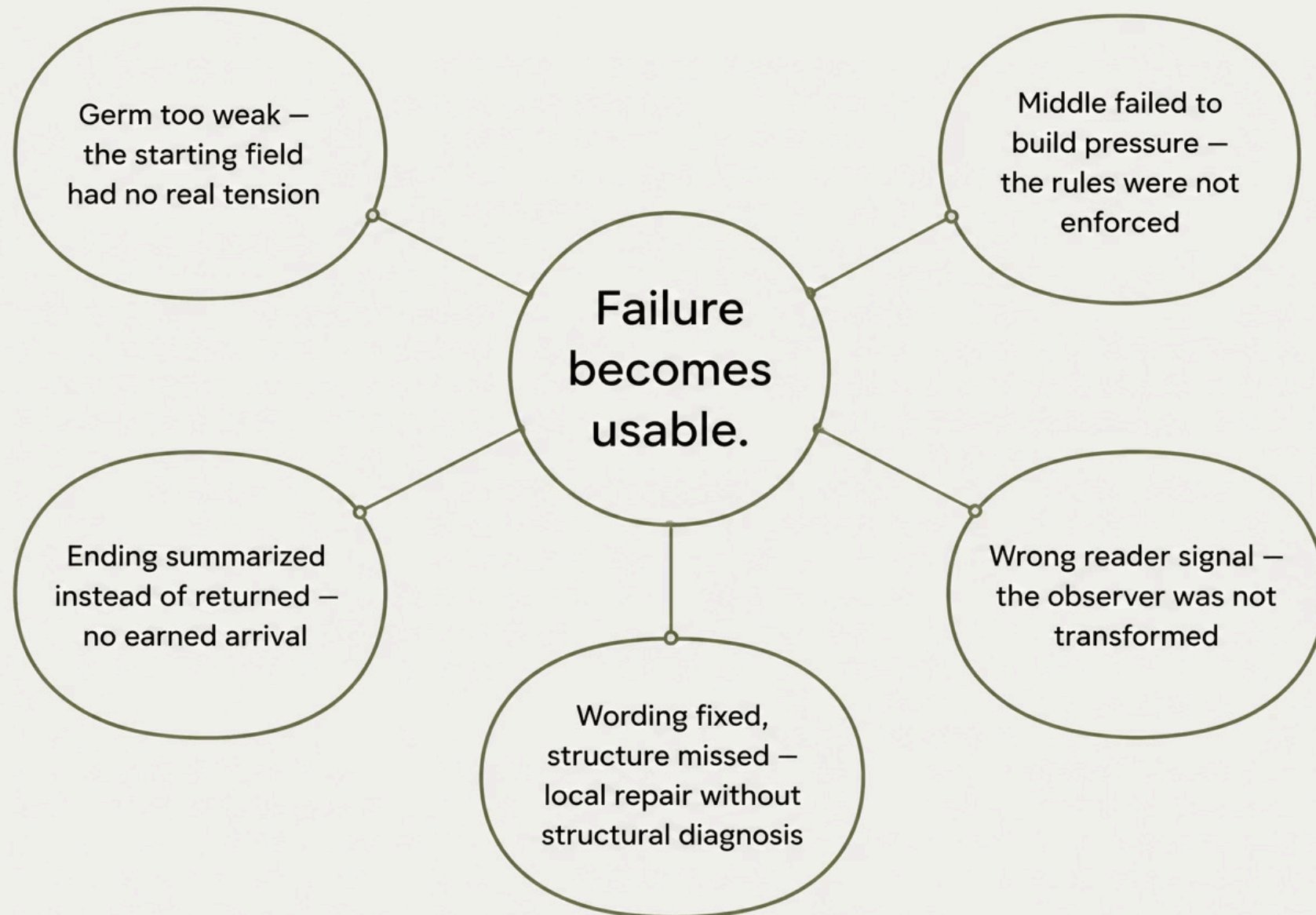
The work begins with a **small field**, develops internal pressure through its middle, and returns changed — the opening is now more necessary than it was.

Observer

The observer begins with **partial understanding**, undergoes pressure as the work resists easy resolution, and rereads the beginning differently.

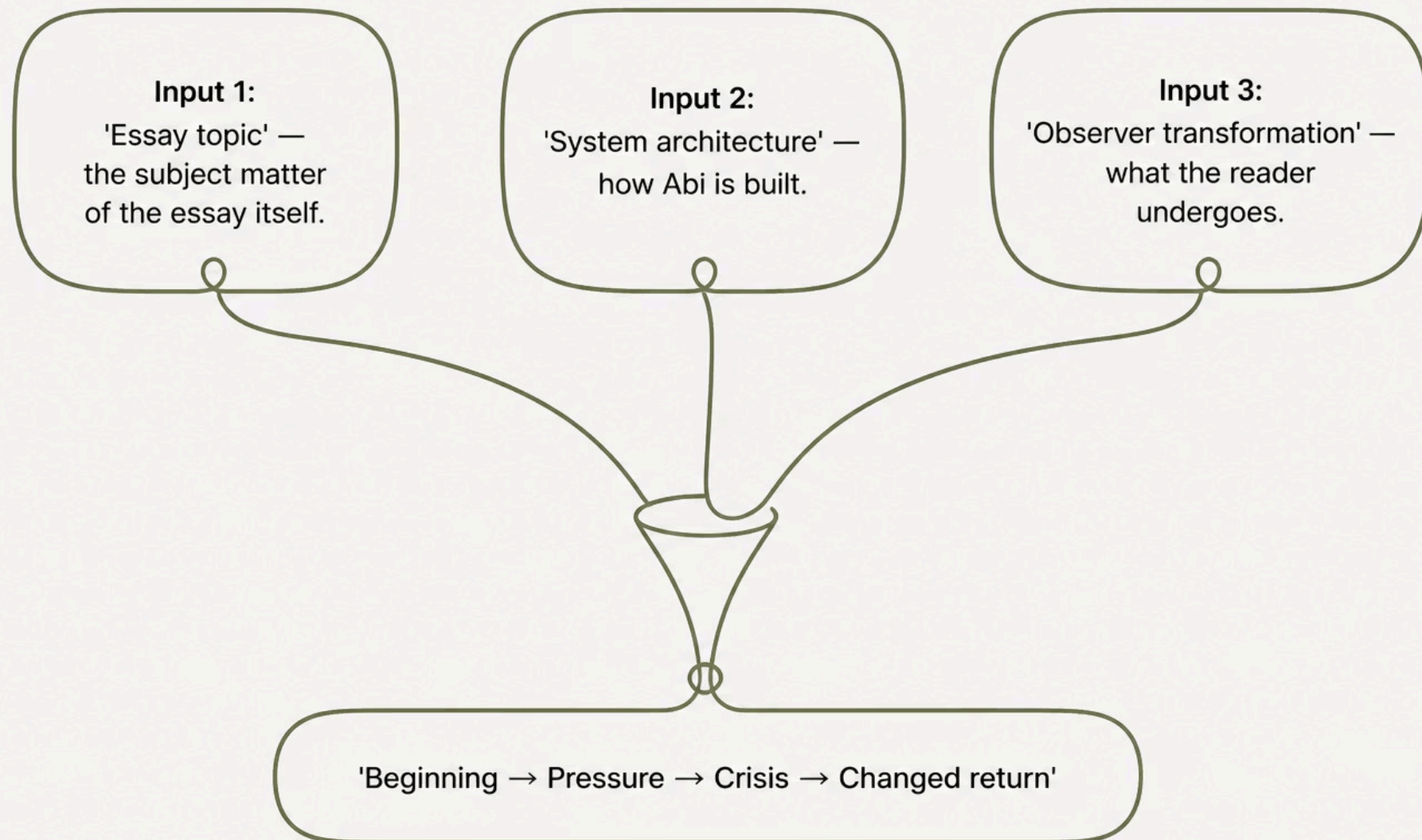
Freedom in alignment

Alignment makes failure usable. Without alignment, the diagnosis is vague: *the essay is not good enough*. With alignment, Abi can ask: was the germ too weak? Did the middle fail to build pressure? Did the ending summarize instead of return? Did the revision fix wording while missing structure?



Abi starts where the signal is cleanest

Abi staThe essay topic, the system architecture, and the observer transformation all use the same pattern: beginning, pressure, crisis, changed return. That constraint is what lets Abi ask whether the system can produce, read, and repair a work whose form matches the transformation it is trying to cause.



The revision loop becomes a learning loop

Once the framework is aligned, revision is no longer just improvement. The goal is for each revision to teach the system something about necessity.

Abi can make a candidate, model what it caused, name a specific weakness, repair that weakness, compare the result against rivals, and refuse finalization when the signal is weak. Each cycle is a lesson about what belongs.

Make Candidate

Simulated
Readers



Limited Repair
& Gate

Name
Weakness

Abi Ear studies small creative decisions

Abi Ear is the part of the system that studies local creative judgment. It asks what a choice is doing inside the work.

One word. Four questions.

Consider a single highlighted word inside a sentence. Abi Ear asks:

- What does this word make the observer **notice**?
- What **future** does it prepare?
- What **pressure** does it store?
- What **weakens** if it changes?

Why local judgment matters

A word is not just a unit of meaning. It is a unit of causation inside the work. Abi Ear is the subsystem that tries to read at that resolution.

Without local judgment, revision operates at the wrong scale — improving sentences while missing the decisions that hold the structure together.

Internal readers track what changed

Abi uses internal reader workers as bounded interpreters. They report concrete effects — not impressions, but changes in the state of reading.

What became salient, what dropped out, what felt overexplained, what changed on a second pass, what claims were actually grounded in the text — these are the reader's concrete report.

First pass

Detail A — noticed, seems incidental

Detail B — salient, foregrounded

Detail C — background, dropped out

Claim D — felt overexplained

Second pass

Detail A — **returns with changed meaning**, now structural

Detail B — fades, was surface

Detail C — intensifies, was load-bearing

Claim D — now grounded in the text

The local physics of creative works

Local physics refers to the rules of belonging inside one artifact. The same idea can work in one piece and feel imported in another.

In one work, broken grammar may be noise. In another, it may preserve voice. In one work, a plain object may be background. In another, it may carry the pressure of the whole piece. Abi learns what *this* work allows, needs, and forbids.

Allowed moves

What this work permits. Broken grammar may preserve voice here. A plain object may carry structural weight.

Needed moves

What this work requires. The pressure it has built demands a specific kind of return — not any return.

Forbidden moves

What this work cannot absorb. A resolution that summarizes when the field demands transformation.

Small wording changes can change the observer's job

A tiny wording change can alter the whole activity of interpretation. The event does not change. The observer's job does.

Version A

The vase shattered. Mara looked at the floor and said, "That went **badly.**"

Reports the event. The observer confirms what happened. No gap to interpret.

EVENT REPORTED

Version B

The vase shattered. Mara looked at the floor and said, "That went **well.**"

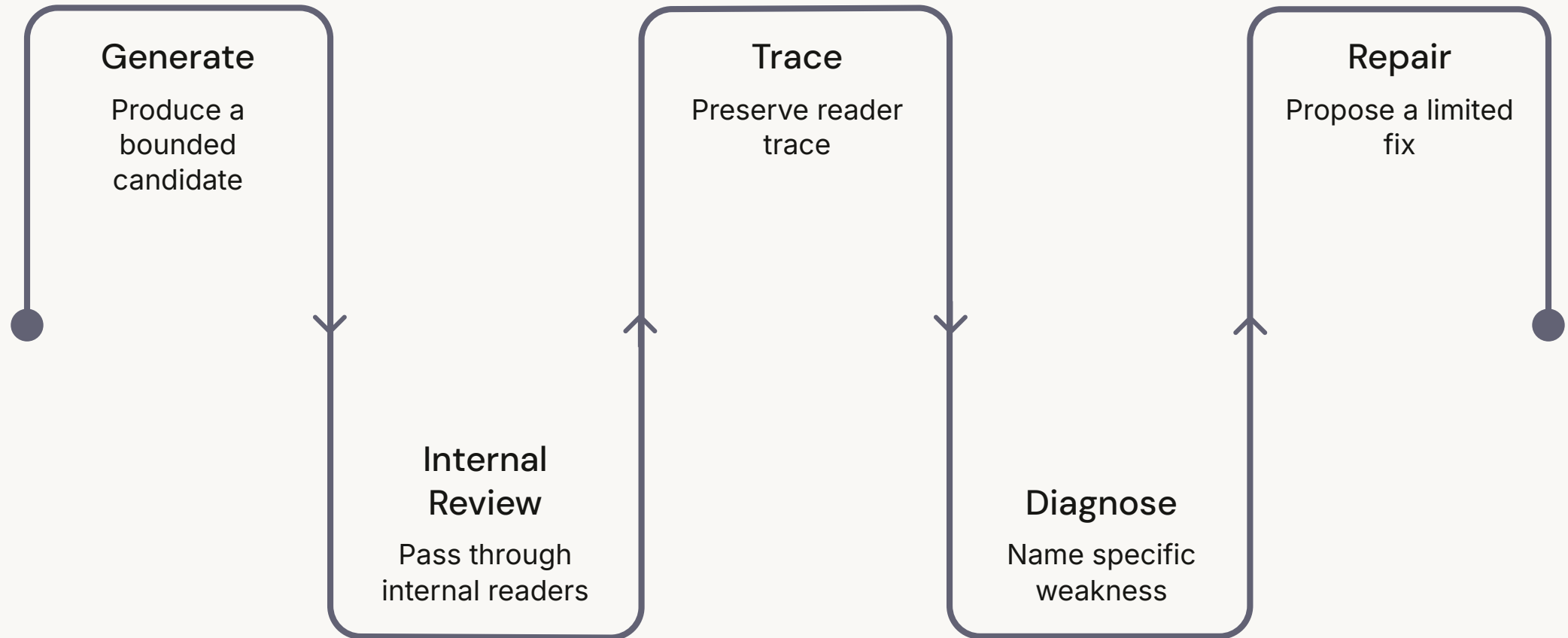
The event did not change. Now the line asks for contradiction, attitude, and irony. The observer must work.

IRONY CREATED

OBSERVER'S JOB CHANGED

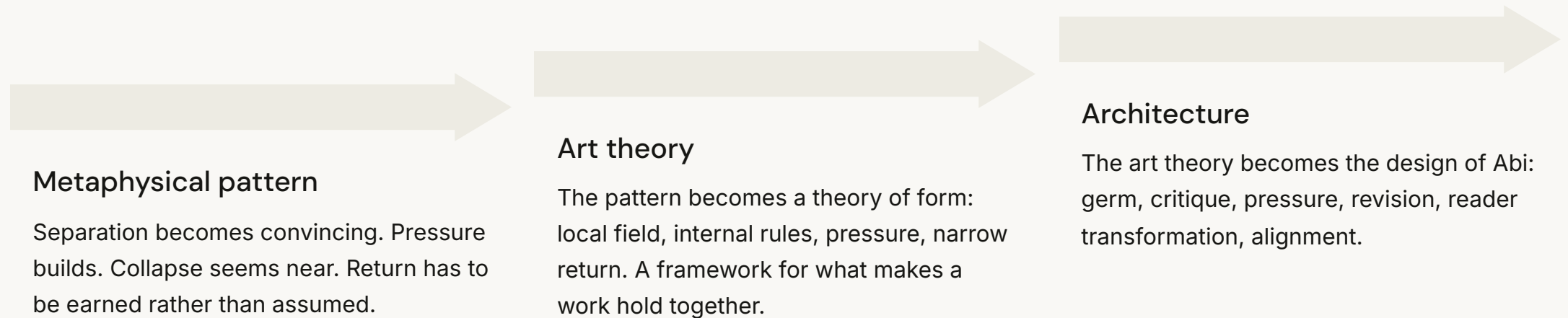
What Abi can do now

Abi can already run a bounded creative cycle, generate a candidate in the narrow domain, pass it through internal readers, preserve a trace of reader effects, name a specific weakness, propose a limited repair, compare the result against the earlier version and a strong rival, and refuse finalization when the signal is weak.



Where the framework came from

Abi began as a metaphysical pattern. That pattern became art theory. The art theory became the architecture.



What Abi is trying to become

Near term, Abi must strengthen the reader model, Abi Ear, and the system's ability to learn from bounded revisions.

